



ANN GOWER LUNT
Oct. 10, 1843 - Jan. 11, 1914
Married April 11, 1863
in Salt Lake City, Utah by Daniel H. Wells



CHAPTER XIX
THE BLACK HAWK WAR
1865 – 1869

In a letter to the *Deseret News*, dated March 15, 1865, Henry wrote about the difficult four months of winter they had endured and the many cattle and horses which had died on the range due to the deep snow. The Indians were in a condition of starvation and nakedness, and their hunger was intensified by the severe winter weather which caused them to prey upon the settler's livestock for food. The Superintendent of Indian Affairs, O. H. Irish, reported on April 1 of that year that the settlers had lost at least half of their cattle and the Indians had lost all of their horses. In fact, a band of Indians started out on a hunt in the middle of February and were driven back by one of the most severe snow storms that ever occurred in the Utah Territory. Irish claimed that hunger also caused the Utes to steal cattle and kill whites in Sanpete Valley.¹

While in Parowan, George A. Smith sent a letter to Salt Lake City on March 15, 1866, to General Daniel H. Wells who was over the militia of the Utah Territory, or what was called the Nauvoo Legion. It contained the following:

Yours of February 27th came to hand yesterday. The reason Majors Haight and Higbee resigned is owing to the failure of the Iron Works and the

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consequent decrease of the population of Cedar. Two full battalions were there formerly, now there are only about seventy men. Henry Lunt is acting as Major over these and the few men at Hamiltons and Kanarra, and has decidedly more men than arms. Respectfully, your brother, George A. Smith²

Hunger had the greatest military impact and probably was the main cause of the Black Hawk War. This was the worst Indian outbreak in the history of Utah. It extended over a period of three years resulting in the loss of many lives and causing an estimated \$1,500,000 in loss of animals and damage to property. A band of Utes, under Chief Black Hawk, were the firebrands that brought on this war. It was waged with such determination by the Indians that, at times, it looked as if the settlers would be compelled to move out of the Territory. It is unknown how the Utes obtained their weapons but the firearms of the Indians were often superior to those used by the whites. They had a number of long-range "Enfield Rifles," which were better guns than the militia possessed. And they also had enough ammunition to use almost unnecessarily. One warrior even had a "Henry Rifle." The Utes were excellent warriors who were proficient with the bow and arrow and were masters of hit-and-run tactics. The bows used by the Indians were relatively silent, powerful, lethal, and could be shot rapidly and effectively. Arrows were roughly 24 inches long and the shaft could penetrate an ox up to half of its length.³

The Indians always struck unforeseen and, early in the war, raided white communities almost at will by using wise timing and taking advantage of the terrain. When pursued, the Utes kept their adversaries at bay through effective delaying actions. They avoided heavy casualties by disengaging when necessary, but limited manpower kept them from pressing their advantage.

The brunt of the strife was borne by the settlers in central Utah, yet Indian raids took place in Sevier, Sanpete, Kane, Paiute, Iron and Washington counties. However, during the Black Hawk War, many Indians remained tranquil and bypassed opportunities to plunder and kill. Some Paiutes (Pihedes) joined with the Utes in their raids, but

the Indians around Cedar City remained quite peaceful. Still, the settlers always stayed alert since they knew Ute warriors were raiding other communities.

On the 24th of July in 1865 the people of Washington, St. George and Santa Clara, with a sprinkling of people from other settlements, started over the red rock which was the beginning of the tortuous road to Pine Valley in order to enjoy a brief respite from the heat in the delightfully cool atmosphere among the pines of that growing community. For two days, Saturday and Sunday, the wagons made their way through Pine Valley village to the "Pinery" farther up. Apostles George A. Smith and Amasa M. Lyman arrived in the forenoon of July 24th accompanied by President William H. Dame, Bishop Henry Lunt and others from Iron County. They held a meeting and after dinner the men laid a large floor of rough lumber on which they held a dance. Another meeting was held consisting of speeches, songs and recitations and then more dancing followed.⁴

Henry wrote the following letter dated January 10, 1866, to George A. Smith who was in Salt Lake City:

It is a general time of good health and good feeling in this place and through the Ward. The Christmas holidays have been commemorated in the usual manner—feasting and dancing. On the 3rd, the Cedar Dramatic Association gave us a treat in the performance of 'The Golden Farmer' and 'A Pleasant Neighbor' which reflected much credit to the members of the association. The next Wednesday evening they performed 'The Rose of Ettrich Vale' and 'Grimshaw Dagshaw and Bradshaw'. The Harmonic Society in this place is in a prosperous condition; Professor John M. Macfarlane is very diligent in teaching music and singing to the active members. Means are now being raised to purchase a set of instruments for a brass band and a cabinet organ. I returned last evening from Pinto Creek—have been settling tithing with the brethren there who feel well and are thriving in that

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beautiful and secluded vale. I could not but notice with great pleasure and satisfaction the labors of Brother Jessie Eldredge who is teaching school. The scholars are learning unusually fast and are much attached to their teacher. They have got the walls up of a substantial stone building for a school house. Winter commenced in good earnest on the 1st day of December and has been extraordinarily severe until the last few days, when it has thawed considerably. Yesterday it rained and snowed all day and lightened and thundered last night. Today the snow has been falling heavy all day, partly melting as it fell, but there is about 12 inches now and a good prospect for more. We have had 30 inches of snowfall here altogether since the 1st of December. Brother Liston came up today from the Santa Clara and reports the winter as having been the severest ever known in Dixie--had good sleighing and the ground froze 10 inches deep. I saw a young man this week who had just come from Parranagate Valley who said the climate in that region was very mild and pleasant and the ground fit to plough. About 150 miners were there and more coming from Reece River. Our wheat crops the past season have proved to be much below the average in consequence of the ravages of the Chintz Bug and early frost; consequently, there will be very little surplus.⁵

A short time after Henry wrote this letter another child, a girl, was born to Henry's second wife, Ann Gower Lunt on January 20, 1866. They named her Jemima Gower Lunt.

An article which was sent in from the Cedar City Ward and Stake appeared in the *Deseret News*:

Sunday, March 25, 1866: A very instructive and pleasant conference was held at Cedar City on this and

the preceding day attended by President Erastus Snow [President of the Southern Mission], Elder Richard Robinson of Pinto Creek, James H. Imlay of Harmony, John Hamilton of Hamilton's Fort, Patriarch Elisha H. Groves of Kanarra, Bishop Willis of Toquerville, and a number of elders from Parowan and neighboring settlements. Much instruction was given and considerable business attended to including the calling of some 15 brethren to go and strengthen the settlements in Long Valley. On the evening of Saturday, March 24, the Dramatic Association of Cedar City gave a theatrical entertainment, playing 'The Rent Day' and 'The Irish Tiger,' which was well received and largely patronized.

Henry wrote a letter on June 10, 1866, which was published in the *Deseret News* on June 28. He commented that the wheat crops looked well but the cold nights had made the gardens late, and frost had killed nearly all the fruit except for a few apples. The settlers had set out a large number of fruit trees and were hoping, in the future, to have an abundance of fruit of all varieties. Henry wrote that the people of Cedar were busy and enjoying good health "with the exception of a few cases of scarlet fever, only two of which terminated fatally."

Another article was published in the *Deseret News* describing the events that took place on July 4, 1866, in Cedar City. There was a customary firing of salutes and raising the Stars and Stripes. A muster of the militia was held and the citizens assembled in the Social Hall at 10:30 in the morning for a meeting. Several men gave speeches including Bishop Henry Lunt. Also, there were several songs and recitations on the program. The afternoon and evening were spent "dancing, singing and in general hilarity."

Henry wrote the following for the *Deseret News* on April 6, 1867:

Cedar City, Iron County Utah. Most of last week was a very stormy time in this part of the country,

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snow fell to the depth of about two feet, but soon thawed off, making the soil too muddy to plough, so we improved the time in laboring on public works and repairing and cleaning out the water sects in the city and fields. This week, since the weather has been finer, a large number of fruit trees have been planted out. I planted out an orchard of 104 apple trees of choice varieties. The apple promises to do well here, and some excellent fruit was raised last season.

Considerable attention is being paid to sheep and wool raising. Our sheep are fast increasing in numbers, but much improvement might be made in the breed. Good care and a change of range are the main things with all breeds. We have built three large corrals the past winter in different places, with a rock house for the herdsmen. We have a good summer herd ground on the east mountain with a couple of large corrals and a house.

Messrs. Samuel Leigh and Co. are building a machine shop to run by water power, which will soon be in operation cutting laths and shingles, wood turning, etc. The health of the people is good and the Indians are peaceable. [signed] Henry Lunt

A son was born on July 18, 1867, to Henry and Mary Ann Wilson Lunt. They named the boy William Wilson Lunt. He was Mary Ann's fifth child and Henry's seventh.

Apparently the settlements in southern Utah had been relatively free from any serious raids by the Indians until the evening of July 21, 1867, when Joseph Fish of Parowan saw Indians seize some cattle. Bravely, Fish rode into the group learning their number and the direction they were heading. He left and gathered eleven men and intercepted the raiders at the mouth of Little Creek Canyon. According to Fish, "We charged the herd full speed, firing whenever we could hear or see anyone. We gave a terrific yell which stampeded the herd, and the Indians took to the hills as quickly as possible

without hardly stopping to return our fire." It was determined there were about fifty warriors and they tried again that night to steal cattle, but the militia was reinforced, and they drove off the Utes once more. The next day the cattlemen near Parowan were ambushed, and the Indians fired from about forty yards distance so fast that the shots seemed to come like hail. Several Indians took favorable positions at the mouth of the canyon and kept up a constant firing of guns for part of the night. However, no one was killed in this ambush. The Black Hawk War's length and cost led to excesses by both sides. On several occasions the whites killed noncombatants, including women and children, as did the Utes. Corpse mutilation was also a factor in how the Indians waged war. The warriors occasionally took the scalps of their victims and defaced their bodies in other ways. This was probably done for cultural reasons, as many Indians believed that damage to the remains of their enemies meant that these foes would be unable to use a complete body against them in the afterlife.⁶

During the duration of the Black Hawk War the whites abandoned at least nine settlements in the areas of Ute uprising. The decision to evacuate was part of an effort to consolidate forces and make defense more efficient. The Indians never besieged towns, even though they fired their guns sometimes near the towns as a diversion. Although this seemed to be a great Indian achievement, the abandoned areas were of little value to the Indians in controlling central Utah because the removal of stock eliminated a potential food source. This was a master stroke by white officials and may be considered the turning point of the war.

Chief Black Hawk led the Utes in surrendering in August 1867, and he clearly acted as their spokesman following the conflict. There were some outbreaks during the following years but the Indians finally concluded a treaty with the United States army at Mount Pleasant, September 7, 1872. Evidence indicates a relatively modest number of Indians followed Chief Black Hawk. However, during this Indian war more than 3,000 men were called into service, which was a large number when considering the sparsely settled communities of the southern part of Utah.⁷

Henry was kept busy in his "callings" as Stake President and

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Bishop, and visited the surrounding communities frequently. On Saturday 14, 1867, he traveled to Harmony and spoke at a meeting there. A Cedar City choir went with him and sang several songs on the program. The Harmony Ward prepared refreshments and held a dance following the meeting.

John M. Macfarlane, representing the Cedar City Ward, wrote the following to the *Deseret News* on Thursday, February 6, 1868:

Winter holds firm sway over the elements here, but appearances indicate that it will not be of long duration. Our Bishop [Henry Lunt] is still busy and persevering in raising money to gather the poor saints from the old countries. He is leaving nothing undone to accomplish this Godlike work, and his philanthropic labors are being crowned with much success. He is full of the spirit of emigration and has already had the pleasure of remitting to President Young nearly \$700 in money, besides contributions in wheat, etc. where money was not come-at-able. When the subject of raising means for the emigration of the poor was first spoken of in this place, it did not seem possible to raise \$100 in money in the settlement, but by various means the above results have been brought about. Even our Sunday School scholars brought in their five and ten cent bills to swell the fund, and still the noble work goes on with unabated vigor.

Our Sabbath meetings are very interesting and well attended, notwithstanding the intense cold and the unfinished state of our Hall. Bishop Lunt has, however, purchased two heating stoves for the Hall which make it more comfortable.

The youths are being encouraged and felt after with fatherly care and counsel. There are three Day Schools in our city during this winter, two taught by female teachers and one by a male teacher. Music is being worked in as one branch of study in the Day Schools,

and a very important one it is, as every teacher who has tried it must confess.

Our choir, under the patronage and encouragement of our leaders, still improves. They gave a concert during the winter which was very satisfactory. Our city fathers have not been idle in their sphere. They have just completed and forwarded the necessary documents for the entry of 639 acres of land for the use and benefit of our citizens, besides having a general care for the welfare of the people here.

Gates and Company's gristmill is about ready for business, having already ground corn and chopped some wheat. Stewart and Chaffin are also pushing their gristmill to completion. Bauer and Company are building machinery for the manufacture of shingles, laths, furniture, etc. Samuel Leigh and Co. are finishing their building and machinery for an iron foundry, making shingles, laths, etc. Our school trustees are trying to finish a school house, and, altogether, our city is kept lively and business like.

Among other things our fast day matters are not forgotten, as the first Thursday of each month comes along and the offerings of the Saints are freely dispensed to the most needy amongst us. We have had more land surveyed for our increasing population. Some small settlements are being formed in our neighborhood. The waters of the Iron Springs are being put onto a very nice patch of land and six or seven families will settle there the coming spring. Winter has been very severe on our sheep. Many of the oldest and poorest have died, and the clip of wool the coming season will be rather slim. Measures are being planned and adopted for better care of our sheep hereafter, and we anticipate a great improvement in taking care of sheep and raising wool in this country.

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A baby girl was born to Henry and Ann Gower Lunt on March 3, 1868, in Cedar City. This baby was Ann's third child; they named her Roselia Gower Lunt.

The following Relief Society minutes, dated June 4, 1868, were written by Ellen Lunt, Henry's first wife, who was secretary of that organization:

According to appointment by Bishop Henry Lunt, the sisters of Cedar City met in the Social Hall for the purpose of being organized into a Female Relief Society. The Bishop presided over the meeting assisted by his counselors, Brothers Samuel Leigh and C. J. Arthur. The Bishop made some very appropriate remarks during which he said if the sisters were willing, he would appoint a Presidentess. He then moved, which was seconded and carried unanimously, that Sister Rachel Whittaker [Ellen's mother] act as President of the Society. He then told her to choose two counselors. She said she would rather he chose them. He then moved that Sister Annabella Haight be First Counselor and Sister Mary Higbee, the Second. He also moved that Sister Ellen Lunt [his first wife] act as Secretary and Sister Alice Bennett as Treasurer of said Society. Carried unanimously. The Bishop gave some good instructions to the sisters. He said he would have rye down the coming fall so that they could have the straw for the making of hats. He also recommended the cultivation of silk and the silkworm and wished them to make a rag carpet for the aisle of the Meeting House by the time President Young came this fall. He instructed the sisters to see to the wants and necessities of the poor. Signed: Ellen Lunt, Sec.

The Relief Society sisters met on July 1, 1868, in the Social Hall. Again, Bishop Lunt presided. He commented that the attendance was not as good as should be, probably because the sisters were busy

making hats, dresses, quilts, etc. for the 4th of July celebration. He reminded them about making the carpet for the church and gave them some advice on teaching their children. He said, "Teach your young children to speak with all modesty and meekness so that they can be heard when they go on errands, and not whisper." He blessed and set apart "Mother Whittaker" and her counselors and gave them each a blessing before he left the meeting in their hands and withdrew. The following were members of the Relief Society:

Elisabeth Adams	Annabella Haight
Louize Adams	Eliza Ann Haight
Mary Ann Armstrong	Mary Ann Haight
Caroline E. Arthur	Margaret Heyborne
Hannah Sarah Barnhurst	Eunice Higbee
Alice Barton	Mary Higbee
Alice Bennett	Elizabeth Hunter
Jane Birkbeck	Mary Hunter
Alice Bladen	Margaret Jones
Mary Bladen	Sage Jones
Barbara Bower	Mary Lapworth
Ellen Bucill	Elisabeth Lathmann
Maria Bulloch	Teressa Lee
Laura Chaffin	Mary Leigh
Sarah M. Chaffin	Mary Lord
Christiana Chatterley	Ann Lunt
Sarah Chatterley	Ellen Lunt
Sister Christopherson	Mary Ann Lunt
Janet Clark	Keturah Macfarlane
Mary Clark	Leonora Mackelprang
Martha Connell	Margaret Mackelprang
Margaret Corry	Eliza McConnell
Mary Elizabeth Davis	Permelea Morrill
Harriet Dutton	Alsie Neilson
Margaret Elliker	Christina Neilson
Ann Gower	Ellen Nelson
Martha Gower	Margaret Nelson

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Letitia Newcomb
Johanna Palmer
Elisabeth L. Parry
Sarah Pugson
Eliza Ann Root
Eliza Shepherdson
Christina Sherratt
Ann Smith
Betsy K. Smith
Margaretta K. Smith
Mary Usher Smith
Mary Ann Stewart
Elisabeth Tait

Mary Ann Thorley
Mary Ann Unthank
Sarah Urie
June Spiking Vance
Charlotte Walker
Emma Walker
Margaret Walker
Ann Elizabeth Webster
Rachel Whittaker
Sarah Williams
Ann Wood
Jane Wood
Mary Wood

In the Relief Society meeting on Thursday, July 16, 1858, Bishop Lunt and Brother Arthur set apart the following sisters to attend upon and administer to the sick: Elisabeth Parry, Eliza Ann Haight, Mary Bladen, Alice Bennett, Mary Ann Unthank, Sarah Urie and Margaret Mackelprang. The Bishop stressed that this was an important calling. On January 7, 1869, Sister Jane Birkbeck was blessed and set apart to visit and attend to the sick. This was done under the hands of President Erastus Snow, who was visiting Cedar City. On Feb. 25 the Society met to quilt, sew, knit and cut carpet rags. Sister Christopherson was set apart to be a midwife to the sisters by Elder Isaac C. Haight and Bishop Henry Lunt.⁸

The Relief Society sisters made many quilts, some for themselves and some to distribute to the needy. Ellen and Ann Gower Lunt made a beautiful quilt which was dyed yellow with sagebrush blossoms. The cloth used in the quilts was first made into clothing and, after the clothing was worn out, the best parts were pieced into quilts.⁹ On June 3, 1869, the treasurer read the financial report which showed their funds had reached the sum of \$319.27, one-half of which had been donated to the Society. Of that amount \$255.25 had been disbursed for the relief of the saints "burned out" at St. Thomas on the "muddy." The sisters had made forty yards of rag carpet, valued at \$1.20 per yard, which they donated for the use of the Social Hall.

Two quilts made from Linsey and Calico had been sold for \$8 each, and the sisters were working on three more. The wife of Erastus Snow wrote a letter to the Relief Society encouraging them in their efforts. Bishop Lunt said that he was pleased with what had been done but wished them to double their labors the following year. He spoke on traditional education and fashion of young girls in the settlement.¹⁰

Henry Lunt wrote a letter to George A. Smith dated December 30, 1868, and after telling about the peace and prosperity and what was taking place in Cedar City, he ended with the following:

The Indians from Beaver to Santa Clara had a huge rabbit hunt in Iron County during the two months of November and December and honored the Bishop with frequent calls, as they found a little flour quite an addition to their rabbit meat.

The first United States Land Office was opened in Salt Lake City in March 1869. Through this office, the settlers could now file for homesteads and get legal title to the land. The Homestead Act initiated by President Lincoln made it possible for any man or woman to acquire a 160-acre farm. It was necessary for the homesteader to cultivate and care for the land and prove good intentions. If this was done, the office would issue a deed to the property after five years.

George A. Smith presided over a special conference held in Parowan March 14, 1869. Erastus Snow and Joseph F. Smith from Salt Lake City were also present. A new L.D.S. Stake was organized, consisting of Parowan, Paragonah, Summit and Cedar City. This change did away with the Cedar Stake which was organized May 20, 1855, and left just the Parowan Stake. William H. Dame was sustained as the President with C. C. Pendleton and Jesse N. Smith as Counselors. Also, a High Council was chosen consisting of men from all four settlements. Henry Lunt was released from the position of Stake President, but remained as Bishop of the Ward.

Another child was born to Henry and Mary Ann Wilson Lunt on January 20, 1870. They gave her the name of Florence Wilson Lunt.

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1. Albert Winkler, "The Ute Mode of War in the Conflict of 1865-68", *Utah Historical Quarterly*, (1992), p. 301.
2. Utah State Archives #1520, Salt Lake City, Utah
3. Albert Winkler, *op. cit.*, p. 309.
4. Erastus Snow, *Erastus Snow Journal*, Chapter 25, S.U.U. Special Collections Library, Cedar City, Utah, p. 383.
5. Andrew Jenson, *L.D.S. Journal History*, " Cedar City Ward,"Entry for January 10, 1866.
6. Albert Winkler, *op cit.*, p. 317.
7. Milton R. Hunter, *History of Utah*, (1922), Page 290
8. Ellen W. Lunt, Secretary, "Cedar Ward Relief Society Minute Book 'A' ," Entry for July 16, 1868, L.D.S. History Library, Salt Lake City, Utah.
9. *Our Pioneer Heritage*, (1942), "Pioneer Quilts," Daughters of the Utah Pioneer: Cedar City Library, p. 63.
10. Ellen W. Lunt, Secretary, *op. cit.*, June 3, 1869.